



Modelling Room Acoustics with a GPU

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Acknowledgements

Many thanks to all who helped me with this dissertation.

Note

This is my work I am no a cheat.

1 Introduction

“There is no competition of sounds between a nightingale and a violin.”

Dejan Stojanovic

The way we perceive sound depends on the environment in which we hear it as well as how the sound was created. Listening to a sound in a space like a church or a cathedral is very different to listening in a bedroom. Being able to predict how a space will affect a sound has practical use in the design of new spaces, particularly those spaces where acoustic performance is critical. A great deal of effort goes into the design of new concert halls. This would be greatly enhanced by accurate acoustic models of spaces. The aim then, of research in this area, is to provide an accurate prediction of how a space will sound after being given its physical properties.

The key technique currently used for these simulations is the finite-difference time-domain (FDTD) method for finding approximate solutions to the wave equation across a three dimensional space. This forms a simple stencil. This stencil process across a vast number of points in memory is well suited to the use of graphics processing units (GPUs) which have high band width graphics memory and can operate on very many points in a massively parallel fashion.

In the work leading up to this report, a novel technique was devised and implemented that performs these simulations. This approach was designed to make best use of graphics memory, which is relatively scarce.

2 Background and Literature Review

“He who loves practice without theory is like the sailor who boards ship without a rudder and compass and never knows where he may cast.”

Leonardo da Vinci

2.1 Room Acoustics

Sound is modelled using the wave equation.

$$E = mc^2$$

2.2 Graphics Processing Units (GPUs)

2.3 The Proposed Data Structure and Method

You can use a label on a figure to refer to it later. The university crest is in ???. Note that you should not use phrases like “the figure above” or “the following figure” since LaTeX may move the figure relative to the text if it cannot be fitted onto the current page.

2.4 Possible Spectral Techniques

While no work was done on this, I am going to talk about it anyway.

3 Design and Implementation

“The first 90 percent of the code accounts for the first 90 percent of the development time...The remaining 10 percent of the code accounts for the other 90 percent of the development time.”

Tom Cargill

3.1 Software Development Process

3.2 Debugging and Profiling Tools

4 Results and Analysis

4.1 Some results

Here are some results.

4.1.1 More results

When showing results you are likely to use tables and graphs. You can create tables easily in Latex.

File names	Satellite	Resolution
worldr	Meteosat	5km
worldg	Meteosat	5km
worldb	Meteosat	5km

Table 1: This is a simple table. More complicated tables can have headings which pass over more than one column

If you want to produce fancier tables than shown in Table 1 refer to the manual.

4.1.2 Graphs

Perhaps the most robust way to include graphs is to create them using whatever package you like (eg Excel, gnuplot, xmgrace, ...) and then convert them to PDF and include them in the same way as was done in Figure ?? for the University Crest. Nowadays you can usually do this with most packages including Microsoft ones.

You can produce the PDF version of Figure 1 from the file `serialscale.gp` using `gnuplot serialscale.gp`.

5 Conclusions

This is the place to put your conclusions about your work.

References

- [1] L.Lamport. *1986 Latex User's Guide and Reference Manual*. Addison Wesley. pp242.

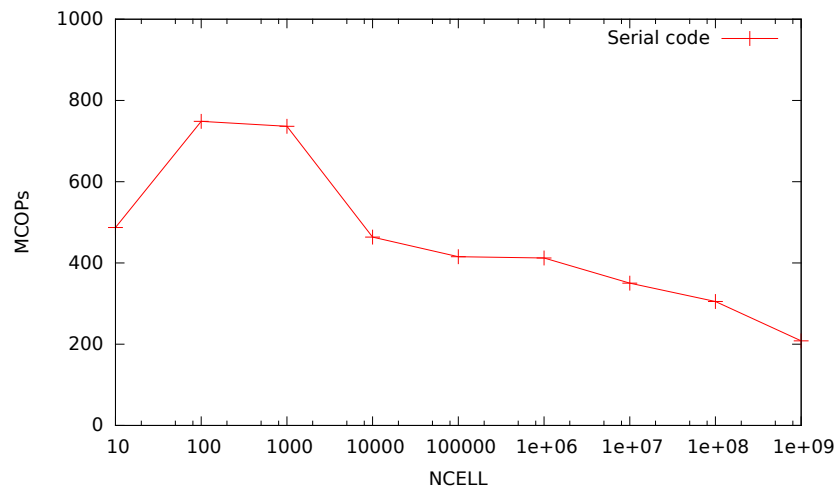


Figure 1: Simple gnuplot example: performance of traffic model

- [2] F.Bloggs. *1993 Latex Users do it in Environments* Int. Journal of Silly Findings. pp 23-29.